

Parish Physical Directory

Response to Questions, Suggestions and Proposed Data Verification Workflow

Points 3 to 11

Scope of this note. This document answers points 3 to 11 of the Parish's questionnaire, which concern how the application works. Points 1, 2 and 12 — ownership, hosting, data location, cost, timeline and support — are commercial and administrative matters and are answered separately.

The short answer to the questionnaire as a whole is yes. The workflow the Parish has proposed is the right one, and it is accepted as specified. The recommendation that family-submitted changes must not directly overwrite the Parish master record is correct, and it is being implemented exactly that way.

How to read the labels. Each answer is marked, so the Parish can see what is already working and what is being added for this exercise:

AVAILABLE TODAY — already built and running in the application today.

TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE — to be built as part of this Directory exercise, before the pilot.

3. Family self-verification and approval workflow

The suggested workflow is accepted in full. Nothing a family submits will change the Parish master record on its own. A submission is a proposal until Achen or an authorised Admin approves it.

Step by step, against the Parish's own list

1. *Existing Parish record is shown to the family.* **AVAILABLE TODAY**
A family login opens directly on its own entry, pre-filled with the Parish record.
2. *Family reviews and submits corrections.* **AVAILABLE TODAY**
The family may edit every field of its own entry, with no restriction on what it proposes.
3. *Submitted changes are placed in Pending Approval.* **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE**
Today a family's edit saves straight to its record. This is the one change of substance: the submission will be written to a separate pending-changes store instead, and the master record left untouched.
4. *Vicar or authorised Admin reviews the proposed changes.* **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE**
A review queue, described in points 4 and 5 below.
5. *Only approved changes are applied to the master record.* **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE**
6. *The approved record becomes eligible for printing.* **AVAILABLE TODAY**
The application already prints only families flagged for the printed book; drafts are visible on screen to Parish staff and never appear in the book. Approval is what sets that flag.
7. *Login by email ID, and families without one.* See below.

Two protections that already exist today

- A family login is not a directory account. It reaches exactly one family — its own — and never the family list, the dashboard or the printed book. Giving a household a login does not hand it every other family's address and telephone number.
- A family cannot renumber itself or put itself into the printed book. The Family ID and the printed-book flag are ignored on a family's submission and stay exactly where the Parish office left them.

What if a family has no email ID?

This is an important question, and the answer is that **no family will be excluded**. Three provisions, and a family may use whichever suits it:

1. **Family ID and PIN login** **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE** — the household signs in with its Parish Family ID and a short PIN printed on the verification slip handed to it. No email address is involved at any step.
2. **Assisted entry** **AVAILABLE TODAY** — an Area Representative or the Parish office signs in and submits on the family's behalf. The submission enters the same approval queue, and the audit trail records who submitted it, so an assisted entry is never mistaken for one the family made itself.
3. **Paper** **AVAILABLE TODAY** — the family is handed a printed slip of its existing record, corrects it by hand and returns it; the office keys it in. Again, the same queue and the same approval step.

It is worth adding that the invitation step does not depend on email either. The application sends no email itself. Messages go out from the Parish's own mail account, and the application simply provides the list of addresses for the Bcc line. Families without email are invited the way the Parish already reaches them — through the Area Representative or the Prayer Group.

Password recovery also works without email. There are no reset links anywhere in the application. A member who forgets a password has it reset by the Parish Administrator from that family's page. This was a deliberate decision, and it is exactly what makes a household without email workable.

4. Which changes require approval?

Yes — different rules for different fields are supported, and the field list is a Parish setting rather than something fixed in the code. **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE**

Routine changes	Mobile number, email, occupation, qualification, photograph.
<i>Light-touch review</i>	Reviewed in a single batch; an authorised Admin may approve them together rather than one at a time.
Significant changes	Family Head, member names, address, date of birth, marriage or wedding anniversary, family composition (a member added or removed), Prayer Group or Area.
<i>Vicar or Admin approval</i>	Approved individually, by Achen or a specifically authorised Admin.
Never family-editable	Family ID, and inclusion in the printed Directory. These are not proposals a family can make at all; they remain with the Parish office.

Our recommendation for the pilot

Start with one single approval queue for everything. It is the simplest thing to operate, there is no risk of a field being mis-classified, and with 5 to 10 pilot families the volume is small. Once the Parish has seen what a real batch of corrections actually looks like, the two-tier split can be switched on for the full rollout.

This is not a rebuild. It is the same review screen either way; the tier only decides who may clear an item and whether batch approval is offered. Moving a field from one tier to the other is a setting the Parish changes itself.

5. Old value versus proposed value

Yes. The reviewer sees the existing value and the proposed value side by side, exactly in the form the Parish has set out, and acts on each line. **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE**

Field	Existing Value	Proposed Value	Action
Address	Existing address	New address	Approve / Reject
Mobile	Existing number	New number	Approve / Reject
Date of Birth	Existing DOB	Proposed DOB	Approve / Reject

Points worth confirming about this screen

- **Only changed fields are listed.** A reviewer reads three lines, not the whole record, which is what makes a hundred families reviewable in an evening.
- **Each line is approved or rejected on its own.** The reviewer can accept a new mobile number and reject a proposed address in the same submission. The rest of the record is left untouched.
- **Photographs are shown side by side**, the existing one against the proposed one.
- **Family composition reads in plain words** — Member added: name, Son; Member removed: name — rather than as a comparison of table rows.
- **Dates are shown in the Directory's own format** (02 - Aug - 1975, and 14 - Mar for an anniversary), so the reviewer is comparing what will actually be printed.
- **A rejection can carry a short reason**, which the family sees the next time it signs in, so a rejected correction is not silently lost.

6. Audit trail and accountability

Yes, and the application already keeps one. **AVAILABLE TODAY** It currently records the events that matter at installation level: whenever an operator opens a particular Parish's screens, every export of data, and every change to the Diocese, Zone or Church structure. Each line records who, what, which Parish, and when.

The log keeps its own copy of the user's name, so a record survives even if the account is later deleted — an audit line that disappears along with its account is not an audit line.

Extended for this exercise

TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE

The same log will carry the verification workflow:

Submitted	Who submitted the change, and when
Reviewed	Who reviewed it, and when
Outcome	Approved or rejected, with the reason where one was given
Master record updated	The moment the approved value reached the Parish record

The log is readable per Parish, newest first, and can be filtered by the type of event. There is no screen anywhere in the application that edits or deletes a log line.

7. Verification status and dashboard

Yes — exactly the chain the Parish has set out. **TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE**

Not Started → Invitation Sent → Family Reviewing → Changes Submitted → Under Parish Review → Approved → Ready for Printing → Printed

The dashboard

The dashboard today **AVAILABLE TODAY** already shows the total families, the number of people, how many families are in the printed book, how many are still drafts, and the birthdays and anniversaries falling in the next thirty days.

For this exercise it gains a count against each status above, each one clicking through to the list of those families — so *17 families still not started* is one click away from the names of those seventeen.

TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE

Area and Prayer Group-wise status

TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE

- Every status view can be narrowed to one Area or Prayer Group.
- The same filter produces a printable follow-up sheet for the Area Representative: Family ID, family head, contact number and current status. That is the sheet the representative actually carries, and it is the practical value of the whole dashboard.

One honest note on Invitation Sent

The application does not send email itself, so this status is recorded when the Parish office marks a batch as sent. It is an accurate record of the Parish's action; it is not a delivery receipt from a mail server, and it should not be read as one.

8. Existing data import

Yes, and this is treated as a precondition of the exercise rather than an optional extra.

TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE The Parish's objective — that no family should key in what the Parish already holds — is the design objective as well. Every family will find its existing record already on screen, and will only need to verify and correct it.

The application already ships an import of this kind for the Diocese, Zone and Church structure **AVAILABLE TODAY**, and the family import is built to the same rules, which have already proved themselves in use:

- **One row per member**, with the Family ID grouping a family's rows together.
- **A dry run first**. The import reports everything it would create, and every row it cannot read, *without writing anything at all*. The Parish sees the outcome before committing to it.
- **Safe to run more than once**. Anything already imported is reported as skipped rather than

duplicated.

- **A rejects file** listing precisely the rows that could not be read and why, so the Parish corrects those rows in the spreadsheet and imports again, instead of hunting for what went missing.
- **Nothing is discarded silently.** Where a date of birth was recorded without a year, for example, the year simply stays empty and the entry still prints correctly.
- **The import creates no logins.** Accounts are a separate, deliberate step — a few hundred families should not quietly become a few hundred live accounts.

One request

Please share one real export of the existing Parish sheet — or a realistic sample with a few families' details altered — as early as possible. The column mapping is written against the Parish's actual sheet, and this single file is the most useful input to the pilot.

9. Family ID, unique identifier

Yes. The Family ID is a permanent Parish identifier. AVAILABLE TODAY

It is independent of address, Prayer Group, Zone and every other detail — none of those form any part of it, so changing them cannot change the ID. Nor is it a database row number: it is the Parish's own numbering, so it survives export, re-import, and the life of the application itself.

- **Unique within the Parish**, ignoring upper and lower case, enforced by the database itself rather than by a screen check.
- **Not editable by a family.** A family's submission can never renumber it.
- **Carried in every export and every report**, so any spreadsheet can be matched back to the master data.
- **Changing it is a Parish office action**, and the audit trail records it.

A technical note, since one installation can serve more than one Parish: each Parish's families are held separately, so two Parishes may both number a family 0001 without any collision, and neither can see the other's records.

10. Printed Directory and final data

Taking the four points in turn.

- **Will only Parish-approved records be included in the final Directory? Yes.** AVAILABLE TODAY
Only a family flagged for the printed book appears in it, and approval is what sets that flag. Parish staff can preview drafts on screen; the printed book never contains them. An empty selection produces nothing — never everything.
- **Can we preview the complete Directory before printing? Yes.** AVAILABLE TODAY
The full Directory renders in the browser exactly as it will print, page numbers included.
- **Can we generate a print-ready PDF suitable for the printer? Yes.** AVAILABLE TODAY
The print view is saved as PDF from the browser. Page size, margins, columns, the entry colours and the starting page number are all Parish settings.
- **Can the Directory layout be adjusted after testing with real Parish data? Yes, and expected.** AVAILABLE TODAY
The printed entry is one shared template and one stylesheet,

so layout, colours and column widths change without touching any data. The current layout reproduces the approved template the Parish has already seen.

One point to settle with the press

A PDF saved from the browser is correct for ordinary printing and for the Parish's own records. If the press asks for a particular production profile — crop marks, bleed, CMYK colour or embedded fonts — that is a known and bounded piece of work, but it needs the press's own specification sheet rather than an assumption on our part. If the Parish can obtain that sheet during the pilot, it can be accommodated well before the full print run.

11. Export and Parish ownership of the final database

Yes. The approved master data exports to CSV, which opens directly in Excel. **AVAILABLE TODAY**

- **One row per member**, flat — the shape that sorts and pivots in a spreadsheet, which is what an export is for.
- **Correct in Excel.** The file is written so that Excel reads it in the right character encoding, which is why names with Malayalam or accented characters open correctly rather than as symbols. This is already handled and already tested.
- **Every export is recorded in the audit log.** Data leaving the system is exactly the event a Parish is entitled to see written down.

Pending Changes export

TO BE BUILT FOR THIS EXERCISE

A separate export, in the columns the Parish has asked for: **Family ID, Family, Field, Existing Value, Proposed Value, Submitted By, Submitted On, Reviewed By, and Status.** This doubles as the working paper for a review meeting — the queue can be read on paper and cleared on screen.

A complete copy the Parish can keep

AVAILABLE TODAY

Two things exist for this, and they answer different needs:

Excel / CSV export	The readable, usable copy — for future Directories, the Annual Report, Prayer Group lists, and any other Parish requirement.
Full backup	A single consistent snapshot of the entire database together with the photograph folder, which can be taken safely while the application is running. This is the whole Directory, photographs included — which a spreadsheet cannot carry.

Both can be produced at any time, and the Parish should hold a copy of each at the end of the exercise. Retrieval of the data if the application is discontinued is addressed under point 12.

Summary

#	Question	Answer
3	Family submissions held pending, not overwriting the master record	Yes — accepted as specified
3	Families without an email ID	Family ID and PIN, assisted entry, or paper
4	Different approval rules for different fields	Yes — one queue for the pilot, two tiers after
5	Existing value against proposed value, before approving	Yes — line by line, approve or reject each
6	Audit trail of who submitted, reviewed and approved	Yes — extends the log already in use
7	Status per family, and a dashboard	Yes — the full chain, filterable by Area or Prayer Group
8	Import existing Parish data from Excel	Yes — dry run first, safe to re-run, rejects listed
9	Family ID permanent across all other changes	Yes — already works this way
10	Approved-only printing, preview, print-ready PDF, adjustable layout	Yes to all four
11	Excel or CSV export of the approved master data	Yes — plus a Pending Changes export and a full backup

Recommended overall workflow — accepted as proposed

Existing Parish Data → Import → Family Verification → Family Submits Changes → Achen or Admin Review → Approval → Master Record Updated → Final Verification → Print-ready PDF and Excel / CSV Export

The principle stated by the Parish is the principle the application will enforce: families are free to propose any correction they wish, and no proposal changes the Parish record until Achen or the authorised Admin has approved it.

Points 1, 2 and 12 — ownership, hosting, data location, cost, pilot timeline and ongoing support — are answered separately.